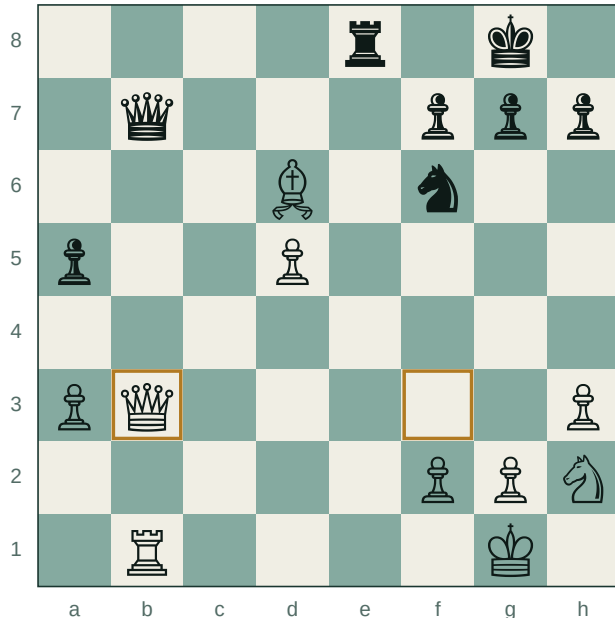


Deflection tactics: Black, move 27

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Qxb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Re1+ 28. Rxe1 Qxb3

27...Re1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From e1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on b1. Recorded reply: **28.Rxe1**.

28...Qxb3 The queen captures the queen on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d6. Check for tactical protection.